

D761

Behavioral Intervention Strategies and Applied Behavior Analysis

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A fourth grader with an emotional disability tears up his math worksheet almost every day. ABC data show that each time, the teacher sends him to the hallway to calm down and the worksheet is not finished. He sits by the window and has a new haircut. What is the most likely function?

- A. Sensory stimulation from tearing paper.
- B. Access to the window view.
- C. Escape from the math task.
- D. Adult attention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's calling out stops when the teacher ignores it and increases when the teacher responds, even with a reprimand. What is the likely function, and what does the teacher's reprimand do?

- A. Escape; the reprimand removes a task.
- B. Tangible; the student wants an item.
- C. Attention; the reprimand is reinforcing the behavior.
- D. Attention; the reprimand is punishing the behavior.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A teacher tells a seventh grader with ADHD that if he finishes his first five problems, he may skip the last five. His on-task work goes up over the next two weeks. The class has 22 students and meets after lunch. What is the teacher using?

- A. Negative punishment
- B. Positive punishment
- C. Positive reinforcement
- D. Negative reinforcement

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student loses five minutes of recess each time she hits a peer, and hitting decreases. What is this?

- A.** Extinction
- B.** Positive punishment
- C.** Negative reinforcement
- D.** Negative punishment

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An FBA finds that a second grader with autism screams during writing to escape the task. The school has a sensory room down the hall and his aide is new. Which replacement behavior should the BIP teach?

- A.** Going to the sensory room whenever he wants.
- B.** Handing the teacher a “break” card to request a short break from writing.
- C.** Raising his hand to ask for a teacher’s attention.
- D.** Sitting quietly and finishing all writing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A teacher stops responding to a student’s whining, which an FBA showed was maintained by attention. On days two and three the whining gets louder and longer. The school had a fire drill on day two, and the student’s grandmother is visiting. What is the best interpretation?

- A.** This is likely an extinction burst; keep the plan consistent while reinforcing the replacement behavior.
- B.** The plan is failing and should be stopped.
- C.** The fire drill caused the change.
- D.** Extinction never causes an increase.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

During an extinction plan, a student's behavior spikes, and on day three a substitute gives in and responds to it. What is the most likely result?

- A.** The student will switch to a new function.
- B.** No effect, because one response does not matter.
- C.** The behavior stops because the need was met.
- D.** The behavior becomes stronger and harder to extinguish.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A sixth grader with an emotional disability often leaves his seat to wander. The teacher gives a point each time he is seated and working, since he cannot wander while seated. The class earned a pizza party last month, and the teacher has two co-teachers on Fridays. Which procedure is this?

- A.** DRI (differential reinforcement of incompatible behavior)
- B.** Group contingency
- C.** DRL (differential reinforcement of low rates)
- D.** DRO (differential reinforcement of other behavior)

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student asks to use the restroom 12 times a day. The goal is not zero but three or fewer. The teacher reinforces days with three or fewer requests. Which procedure fits?

- A.** DRA
- B.** DRL
- C.** Extinction
- D.** DRO

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An FBA team drafts a target behavior for an eighth grader: “The student is disrespectful in class.” The team meets in a conference room with a broken projector, and the student is new to the district. Which rewrite is an operational definition?

- A. Is angry because he is new to the district.
- B. Says a swear word or refuses aloud within 10 seconds of a teacher direction.
- C. Shows a bad attitude toward adults.
- D. Is always disrespectful during every class.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11.

A fifth grader with an emotional disability has most outbursts on Mondays. His mother reports he stays with his father on weekends and often sleeps little. The school has a new principal and just started a garden club. What should the plan address?

- A. Ignore the home information, since only school events matter.
- B. Enroll him in the garden club.
- C. Treat the weekend sleep loss as a setting event and add Monday supports, such as a calm check-in and an easier first task.
- D. Add a harsher consequence for Monday outbursts.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A new teacher writes a referral for a third grader who looks down when being corrected, calling it defiance. The student’s family recently moved from another country, and he is in the school’s soccer program. What should the teacher do first?

- A. Learn what the behavior means for the student, such as by talking with the family, before treating it as a problem.
- B. Refer him for an emotional disability evaluation.
- C. Give him a behavior chart for eye contact during soccer.
- D. Keep the referral, since eye contact is a school rule.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A fourth grader with an emotional disability tears up his math worksheet almost every day. ABC data show that each time, the teacher sends him to the hallway to calm down and the worksheet is not finished. ~~He sits by the window and has a new haircut.~~ What is the most likely function?

Target word: function from ABC data **Decides:** The consequence is removal from the task.

A	Confusion set	The behavior's form suggests sensory, but the consequence points to escape.
B	Camouflage	His seat by the window is not what follows the behavior.
C	Correct	Tearing the paper reliably ends the demand.
D	Adjacent category	He is sent away from adults; the consistent result is no math.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A student's calling out stops when the teacher ignores it and increases when the teacher responds, even with a reprimand. What is the likely function, and what does the teacher's reprimand do?

Target word: function when a reprimand reinforces **Decides:** Any teacher response, even a reprimand, maintains it.

A	Confusion set	Nothing about a task being removed is described.
B	Adjacent category	No object is gained.
C	Correct	If a reprimand makes behavior increase, it works as reinforcement.
D	Inverted operation	Punishment decreases behavior; this behavior increases.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A teacher tells a seventh grader with ADHD that if he finishes his first five problems, he may skip the last five. His on-task work goes up over the next two weeks. ~~The class has 22 students and meets after lunch.~~ What is the teacher using?

Target word: name the procedure **Decides:** Something unpleasant is removed and the behavior increases.

A	Inverted operation	Punishment would decrease behavior; on-task work increased.
B	Inverted operation	Nothing unpleasant is added, and behavior went up.
C	Confusion set	Nothing is added; work is taken away.
D	Correct	Removing part of the task increases the target behavior.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A student loses five minutes of recess each time she hits a peer, and hitting decreases. What is this?

Target word: name the procedure **Decides:** A preferred item is removed and behavior decreases.

A	Adjacent category	Extinction withholds the reinforcer for the behavior; here an unrelated privilege is removed.
B	Confusion set	Nothing was added; recess was taken away.
C	Inverted operation	Reinforcement increases behavior; hitting decreased.
D	Correct	Removing something wanted to decrease behavior is negative punishment.

5. Answer B Concept 3

An FBA finds that a second grader with autism screams during writing to escape the task. ~~The school has a sensory room down the hall and his aide is new.~~ Which replacement behavior should the BIP teach?

Target word: functionally equivalent replacement **Decides:** Must meet the escape need in an acceptable way.

A	Camouflage	Uses the room detail; unlimited access does not teach a request tied to the task.
B	Correct	Gets the same escape outcome in an acceptable, easy way.
C	Adjacent category	Serves an attention function, not escape.
D	Dropped element	A desired behavior, but it does not meet the escape need, so screaming stays more effective.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A teacher stops responding to a student's whining, which an FBA showed was maintained by attention. On days two and three the whining gets louder and longer. ~~The school had a fire drill on day two, and the student's grandmother is visiting.~~ What is the best interpretation?

Target word: why behavior increased **Decides:** Withholding reinforcement often causes a temporary spike.

A	Correct	A brief increase is expected when reinforcement stops.
B	Inverted operation	Stopping now teaches that louder whining works.
C	Camouflage	A single event does not explain a two-day pattern after the plan began.
D	Absolute language	Bursts are a common, predictable effect.

7. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

During an extinction plan, a student's behavior spikes, and on day three a substitute gives in and responds to it. What is the most likely result?

Target word: effect of reinforcing during a burst **Decides:** Reinforcing the burst teaches the student that escalating works.

A	Adjacent category	The function stays the same; the behavior is reinforced.
B	Absolute language	Even one reinforced burst teaches escalation.
C	Inverted operation	Meeting the need through the behavior strengthens it.
D	Correct	Intermittent reinforcement during a burst builds persistence.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A sixth grader with an emotional disability often leaves his seat to wander. The teacher gives a point each time he is seated and working, since he cannot wander while seated. ~~The class earned a pizza party last month, and the teacher has two co-teachers on Fridays.~~ Which procedure is this?

Target word: name the DR type **Decides:** The reinforced behavior physically cannot occur with the problem behavior.

A	Correct	Sitting and working is incompatible with wandering.
B	Camouflage	The pizza party detail suggests group rewards; this plan targets one student.
C	Confusion set	DRL reinforces fewer occurrences, not a competing behavior.
D	Confusion set	DRO reinforces the absence of behavior for an interval, not a specific behavior.

9. Answer B Concept 5 · transfer

A student asks to use the restroom 12 times a day. The goal is not zero but three or fewer. The teacher reinforces days with three or fewer requests. Which procedure fits?

Target word: DR type when the goal is fewer, not none **Decides:** Reinforcing a lower rate of a behavior that is acceptable in small amounts.

A	Adjacent category	No alternative behavior is named.
B	Correct	Reinforces a reduced rate of a behavior that is fine at low levels.
C	Absolute language	Ignoring all requests would deny a legitimate need.
D	Confusion set	DRO reinforces zero occurrences, which is not the goal.

10. Answer B Concept 6

An FBA team drafts a target behavior for an eighth grader: “The student is disrespectful in class.” The team meets in a conference room ~~with a broken projector, and the student is new to the district.~~ Which rewrite is an operational definition?

Target word: observable, measurable definition **Decides:** Two observers could count it the same way.

A	Camouflage	Guesses an inner state and cause; not observable.
B	Correct	Names observable actions and a clear time frame.
C	Dropped element	Still a label, not an observable behavior.
D	Absolute language	Adds absolute words without defining behavior.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A fifth grader with an emotional disability has most outbursts on Mondays. His mother reports he stays with his father on weekends and often sleeps little. ~~The school has a new principal and just started a garden club.~~ What should the plan address?

Target word: setting-event strategy **Decides:** A distant condition (little sleep after weekends) raises the chance of behavior.

A	Absolute language	Setting events outside school often affect school behavior.
B	Camouflage	The new club does not address the Monday pattern.
C	Correct	Changing conditions tied to setting events prevents behavior.
D	Inverted operation	Focuses only on consequences and ignores the known trigger.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A new teacher writes a referral for a third grader who looks down when being corrected, calling it defiance. The student’s family recently moved from another country, ~~and he is in the school’s soccer program.~~ What should the teacher do first?

Target word: culturally responsive first step **Decides:** Looking down may show respect in the student’s culture.

A	Correct	Some cultures teach children to look down to show respect to adults.
B	Adjacent category	Jumps to disability without checking for a cultural difference.
C	Camouflage	The soccer detail is irrelevant; the step is to understand the behavior.
D	Absolute language	Treats one cultural norm as the only correct one.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Functions of behavior	Behavior serves to get something (attention, tangibles, sensory input) or escape/avoid something (tasks, people, sensations); the consequence that reliably follows reveals the function.	Naming the function from what the behavior looks like rather than what it gets the student.	ABC data where the same consequence keeps following the behavior.
2	Reinforcement vs. punishment, positive vs. negative	Reinforcement increases behavior and punishment decreases it; positive means something is added and negative means something is removed.	Thinking negative reinforcement means punishment.	“Removing” or “adding” something and whether the behavior goes up or down.
3	Functionally equivalent replacement behavior	A replacement behavior must meet the same need as the problem behavior and be easier and quicker to use.	Picking a replacement that is simply “good behavior” but does not get the student what the problem behavior got.	A BIP lists a replacement behavior after an FBA.
4	Extinction burst	When reinforcement for a behavior stops, the behavior often gets worse briefly before it declines.	Concluding the plan failed and quitting when behavior spikes.	Behavior increases in the first days after reinforcement is withheld.
5	Types of differential reinforcement	DRA reinforces an alternative behavior, DRI reinforces a behavior that cannot occur at the same time, DRO reinforces the absence of the behavior for an interval, and DRL reinforces lower rates.	Mixing up DRI and DRA, or DRO and DRL.	A plan that reinforces a specific other behavior, an incompatible behavior, time without the behavior, or fewer occurrences.
6	Operational definitions	Define target behavior in observable, measurable terms so two observers would agree on each occurrence.	Using labels such as “disrespectful” or “angry.”	An FBA or data sheet names the target behavior.
7	Antecedents and setting events	Antecedents happen right before behavior; setting events are more distant conditions (sleep, hunger, a hard morning) that make a behavior more likely; both can be changed to prevent behavior.	Only changing consequences and ignoring what sets off the behavior.	Behavior happens mostly on certain days, after certain events, or during certain tasks.
8	Culturally responsive behavior practice	Check whether a behavior reflects a cultural or communication difference before treating it as a problem, and teach expectations explicitly rather than assuming shared norms.	Labeling culturally normal behavior (such as eye contact norms or overlapping talk) as defiance.	A behavior is judged by one set of norms without asking what it means to the student.

Course scope (public description): Behavioral Intervention Strategies and Applied Behavior Analysis prepares special education teachers to work effectively with students exhibiting challenging behaviors, with a focus on

students with behavioral and emotional exceptionalities. This course provides an overview of behavior disorders and their characteristics, as well as appropriate research-based intervention strategies, including positive behavior intervention and supports, multitiered systems of support (MTSS), applied behavior analysis, replacement behavior, and reinforcement strategies, culturally responsive practices, and data collection and assessment methods. After completing this course, learners emerge prepared to strategize and recommend adjustments to the learning environment that support positive behavior and student success in the classroom and beyond. This course also examines behavioral assessment and analysis, functional behavior assessment (FBA), and the creation and monitoring of behavioral improvement plans (BIP) that can be implemented in an authentic learning environment.